

POL40970 - The Politics of European Governance

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University College Dublin

2024/2025

Term 1



Introduction

The European Union (EU) currently consists of 27 European countries. It has evolved into a political community that deeply affects the daily lives of its citizens. How can we explain the process of European Integration? What does the political structure of the EU look like? The module surveys the development of European integration and introduces students to the EU's political system. We will discuss theories of European integration and examine major challenges, that the EU faces at the beginning of the 21st century. The module is research lead, in that it focuses upon the political science literature that seeks to explain various aspects of European integration. This is reflected in the extensive reading list provided with the module.

The module is aimed at those wanting a full and detailed introduction to (1) the history and theories of European integration; (2) the political institutions of the EU and its policy-making process; and (3) current and future challenges facing the EU as a political system. The module does not assume any prior knowledge of the EU or EU politics.

Module structure

The module adopts a seminar format, placing significant responsibility on students to direct individual class sessions. This approach necessitates extensive reading, critical reflection, and regular articulation of your understanding of the material. Each week, different student groups will lead the discussion, preparing a presentation to introduce the topic to their peers and facilitating the seminar for the first hour. To support academic development, a peer-review exercise will assist students in refining their research paper drafts. The module culminates in a final group project, which serves as the end-of-module assessment. Further details regarding assessment requirements are provided in subsequent sections.

Learning outcomes

At the end of this module students will be able to:

- Trace and analyse the historical evolution of European integration, from the European Coal and Steel Community to the contemporary European Union.
- Evaluate the interplay and policy-making processes of the EU's three main legislative institutions.
- Apply diverse theoretical frameworks to critically assess European integration.
- Examine and compare various EU policy domains, assessing the Union's role and effectiveness in each area.
- Articulate and communicate complex concepts related to European integration, both orally and in writing.
- Critically evaluate current challenges facing the EU and project future scenarios, drawing on theoretical perspectives covered in the module.

- Develop research and analytical skills through engagement with academic literature on European politics and governance.
- Enhance collaborative and presentation skills through group projects and seminar leadership.

Module assessment

Module grading scheme

- Running a seminar: 25% (includes outline & materials)
- Peer-review work: 25%
- Research paper: 50%

Student-led seminar

Students will be required to lead discussion as part of a group once during the semester (preparation of handouts and/or overheads recommended). Presentations will relate to the seminar topics for a particular week, and topics will be assigned at the beginning of the term.

Peer review

The peer review process is central to publishing work in academia. Part of your assessment for this module will therefore involve peer reviewing one each others' work. Students will be required to submit a first draft of their group project proposal on **4 November 2024**. The draft assignments will then be distributed for peer review. Each student is required to write a review of two papers. These reviews are due on **12 November 2024** and are graded by the instructor and then returned to the authors. The advantage of this approach is that students can use these reviews to improve their work when redrafting their final research paper for submission. A full set of peer-review guidelines will be distributed before this exercise.

Through this process you will:

- Learn how to carefully read a piece of writing, with attention to the details of the piece in terms of structure and content (whether the piece is your own or another writer's);
- Learn how to strengthen your writing by taking into account the responses of actual and anticipated readers;
- Make the transition from writing primarily for yourselves or for an instructor to writing for a broader audience
- Learn how to formulate and communicate constructive feedback on a peer's work;
- Learn how to gather and respond to feedback on your own work.

Research paper

Students will submit a single well developed research paper on a topic relevant to European integration. This paper should be no longer than **5,000 words** including bibliography, and should analyse an issue of importance relating to the EU or European integration that merits academic research. The analysis should be original and should include an evaluation of approaches to understanding, resolving or further investigating the question. This paper is not a literature review and marks will be awarded for applying original ideas or approaches to established thoughts on the issue. The lecturer will provide plenty of advice and help in choosing a topic and an appropriate research methodology. It is important that students begin to think about the topic they wish to write about immediately, as this is not a trivial undertaking. Identifying a good research question from the start will save much work down the line. The deadline for the first draft of the research paper for peer review is **4 November 2024**. It is essential that a first draft is submitted for this date so that you can receive peer reviews from your peers. The deadline for the final paper is **23:59pm on 6 December 2024**. The research paper will be submitted through Brightspace.

Important dates

- **4 November 2024**: First draft of assignment due
- **5 November 2024**: Peer-review workshop
- **12 November 2024**: Peer-review assignment due
- **6 December 2024**: Final paper due

Use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools

I encourage the use of generative AI tools when completing the assignments for this module, but all work relying on AI generated content must adhere to the highest academic standards. Users of this technology must be aware of what it can and more importantly, what it cannot do well. It is crucial for you to exercise judgement when evaluating the quality and reliability of content generated through AI platforms. AI is not a panacea for all writing challenges; it will not automatically generate a flawless, logically coherent, and factually correct assignment. Instead, use AI as a tool to tackle specific issues such as brainstorming and idea formation, literature discovery, and text drafting issues. View your preferred AI platform(s) as useful but imperfect tools that can offer inspiration, new perspectives, and supplementary areas for research for your own work. In-depth research on your part remains essential to ensure coherent, factual, and scientifically informed perspectives in your assignment. Always cross-reference the information AI offers against other independent and reliable sources.

AI use must be in line with UCD's policies on academic integrity and adhere to the highest academic standards. See here for details: <https://libguides.ucd.ie/academicintegrity>.

Documenting AI use (mandatory)

Since generative AI is such a novel tool in an academic context, we do not yet fully understand what it is capable of and these capabilities are evolving quickly. What was impossible today might well become trivial tomorrow (keeping in mind the academic standards mentioned above). In order to address this you are expected to provide an account of the tools used and the way in which they were used in a **mandatory appendix** to your assignment. This appendix will be assessed as part of the assignment, with grade points awarded for effective communication of the methods used to generate content. For each instance where a generative AI tool is used, you need to provide:

1. An in-text citation or footnote. For example:
 - “Some AI-generated text (OpenAI 2023)”
2. A bibliographic reference to the tool used and the date of access
3. An entry in the mandatory AI appendix detailing how the tool was used. For example:

AI tool used	Explanation	Prompt used
ChatGPT	Topic brainstorming	“Provide an overview of problems associated with the current EU legislative process.”
ChatGPT	Topic brainstorming	“Provide a set of policy recommendations to address these problems.”
Elicit	Literature search	“Compile a list of academic publications detailing some of the problems with the legislative process of the European Union.”

Table 1: Example table demonstrating how generative AI was use to complete policy brief assignment

Generative AI tools and apps:

Below I have listed some AI tools that might help you complete your assignment:

- Brainstorming
 - ChatGPT: <https://chat.openai.com>
 - Bing in creative mode (GPT4 for free): www.bing.com
 - Claude: <https://claude.ai>
- Literature discovery
 - Elicit: <https://elicit.org>
 - Semantic Scholar: <https://www.semanticscholar.org>

- Perplexity: <https://www.perplexity.ai>
- SciSpace: <https://typeset.io>
- Structure and drafting
 - Grammarly: <https://www.grammarly.com>
 - Quillbot: <https://quillbot.com/>
 - Jasper: <https://www.jasper.ai/>
 - Jenni: <https://jenni.ai>

Module readings

Required Readings:

The following text shall be used extensively throughout the module, so it is recommended that it is purchased:

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. 6th Edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Further reading:

In addition to the readings required for each topic, a series of recommended readings are also included in the syllabus. These readings will generally not be discussed in class, but are useful for those who wish to explore a particular topic in more detail. They will also be very useful when approaching the essay assignment, for which you are required to demonstrate a more in-depth understanding of your chosen topic.

The following are good general texts on the EU and EU politics.

- Nugent, N. (2006). *Government and Politics of the European Union*. 6th ed. Duke University Press.
- Peterson, J. & Bomberg, E. (1999). *Decision-Making in the European Union*. New York: St. Martin's Press.
- Peterson, J. & Shackleton, M. (2006). *The Institutions of the European Union*. 2nd ed. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Richardson, J. (2005). *European Union: Power and Policy-Making*. 3rd ed. London: Routledge.
- Bache, I. & George, S. (2006). *Politics in the European Union*. 2nd ed. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Moravcsik, A. (1998). *The Choice for Europe*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press.
- Rosamond, B. (2000). *Theories of European Integration*. New York: St. Martin's Press.

- Cini, M. & Bourne, A.K. (2006). *Palgrave Advances in European Union Studies*. New York: Palgrave.
- Jorgensen, K.E., Pollack, M.A., & Rosamond, B. (2007). *The Handbook of European Union Politics*. New York: Sage Publications.

In addition to these readings, students should keep up to date on current European affairs by reading daily newspapers, or one of the many websites devoted to EU politics. These websites include the following:

- <http://www.euobserver.com>
- <http://europa.eu.int>
- <http://www.eupolitics.com>
- <http://www.ft.com>
- <http://blogs.lse.ac.uk/euoppblog/>
- <http://blogs.lse.ac.uk/brexit/>

Finally, each week a number of study questions are provided in order to guide your thinking about the topics being discussed and the required readings. These study questions will form the basis of the seminar topics covered and so careful consideration of the issues they raise should help you get to grasp with the issues being dealt with.

WEEKLY READING LIST

PART I: THE HISTORY AND THEORIES OF EUROPEAN INTEGRATION

Week 1: The Origins of the EU, and the development of Integration Theory.

Study question

- What are the main milestones that the integration process in Europe went through? How has the European integration project developed over time and how has the policy remit of the EU evolved?
- Why did neofunctionalists like Ernst Haas believe that the process of European integration, having begun so modestly, would snowball into an ongoing process of political integration? Are you convinced by the idea of spill-over effects proposed by the neofunctionalists as an explanation of the integration process?
- By the late 1950s, the neofunctionalist spill-over processes predicted by Ernst Haas seemed to be in full swing, only to be disrupted in the 1960s by French President Charles de Gaulle. Looking beyond the personality of de Gaulle, (1) analyze why the decades of the 1960s and 1970s appeared to have falsified Haas' neofunctionalism, and (2) assess whether the 1960s and 1970s were a period of progress, or rollback, or a mix of the two, in the integration process.

- Many saw the Single European Act (SEA) to be an effort to reinvigorate the integration process after several decades of stagnation, but the explanations for the SEA found in the required readings differ. What are the differences between the respective explanations for the SEA put forward by Zysman and Sandholtz and Moravcsik. Which argument is more persuasive, and why?
- Brexit is the first example of a member state trying to leave the EU. Can the existing theories of European integration shed light on the Brexit process and any likely outcomes?

Required Readings

- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2011. The political system of the European Union. Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 1.
- Schmitter, P.C. (2006). Ernst B. Haas and the legacy of neofunctionalism. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 12(2): 255-272.
- Stone Sweet, A. & Sandholtz, W. (1997). European Integration and Supranational Governance. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 4(3): 297-317.
- Moravcsik, A. (1998). *The Choice for Europe*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press. Chapter 1.

Further reading

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. 6th Edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapters 4 and 5.
- Jones, E., Kelemen, R.D. and Meunier, S. 2016. Failing forward? The Euro crisis and the incomplete nature of European integration. *Comparative Political Studies*, 49(7), pp.1010-1034.
- Marks, G. (2011). Europe and Its Empires: From Rome to the European Union. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 50(1): 1-20.
- Haas, E.B. (1958). *The Uniting of Europe*. Stanford: Stanford University Press.
- Hoffmann, S. (1966). Obstinate or Obsolete? The Fate of the Nation-State and the Case of Western Europe. *Daedalus*. 95(3).
- Deutsch, K.W. et al. (1957). *Political Community in the North Atlantic Area: International Organization in the Light of Historical Experience*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.
- Diebold, W. (1959). *The Schuman Plan: A Study in Economic Cooperation, 1950-1959*. New York: Praeger.
- Haas, E.B. (1976). Turbulent Fields and the Theory of Regional Integration. *International Organization*. 30: 173-212.
- Monnet, J. (1978). *Memoirs*. New York: Doubleday.

- Moravcsik, A. *The Choice for Europe*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press. Chapter 2.
- Pollack, M.A. 2003. *The Engines of European Integration: Delegation, Agency and Agenda Setting in the EU*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Pollock, M.A. 2005. Theorizing the EU: International Organization, Domestic Polity, or Experiment in New Governance? *Annual Review Political Science*. 8, pp.357–98.
- Rittberger, B. (2001). Which Institutions for Post-War Europe? Explaining the Institutional Design of Europe’s First Community. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 8(5): 673-708.
- Caporaso, J. (1998). Regional integration theory: understanding our past and anticipating our future. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 5(1): 1–16.
- Mattli, W. (1999). Explaining regional integration outcomes. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 6(1): 1–27.
- Risse, T. (2005). Neofunctionalism, European identity, and the puzzles of European integration. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 12(2): 291–309.
- Corbett, R. (1987). The 1985 Intergovernmental Conference and the Single European Act. in Roy Pryce (ed.), *The Dynamics of European Union*. New York: Croom Helm.
- Tranholm-Mikkelsen, J. (1991). Neofunctionalism: Obstinate or Obsolete? *Journal of International Studies*. 20(1): 1-22.
- Moravcsik, A. (1993). Preferences and Power in the European Community: A Liberal Intergovernmentalist Approach. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 31: 473–524.
- Bickerton, C.J., Hodson, D. and Puetter, U. 2014. The new intergovernmentalism: European integration in the post-Maastricht era. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 53(4), pp.703–22.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2015a. What’s the news in ‘new intergovernmentalism’? A critique of Bickerton, Hodson and Puetter. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 53(4), pp.723–30.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2015. Liberal intergovernmentalism and the euro area crisis. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(2), pp.177-195.
- Puetter, U. 2016. The centrality of consensus and deliberation in contemporary EU politics and the new intergovernmentalism. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.601-615.
- Puetter, U. and Fabbrini, S. 2016. Catalysts of integration—the role of core intergovernmental forums in EU politics. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.633-642.

- Kleine, M., and Pollack, M. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism and Its Critics. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1493–1509.
- Moravcsik, A. 2018. Preferences, Power and Institutions in 21st-century Europe. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1648-1674.
- Meunier, S., and Vachudova, M. A. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism, Illiberalism and the Potential Superpower of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1631–1647.
- Hix, S. 2018. When Optimism Fails: Liberal Intergovernmentalism and Citizen Representation. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1595–1613.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism and the Crises of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1578–1594.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2018. European integration (theory) in times of crisis. A comparison of the Euro and Schengen crises, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 25(7), pp.969-989
- Schmidt, V. A. 2018. Rethinking EU Governance: From Old to New Approaches to Who Steers Integration. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1544–1561.
- Naurin, D. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism in the Councils of the EU: A Baseline Theory?. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1526–1543.
- McNamara, K. R. 2018. Authority Under Construction: The European Union in Comparative Political Perspective. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1510–1525.
- Jones, E. 2018. Towards a theory of disintegration, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 25(3), pp.440-451.
- Rauh, C., 2019. Between neo-functionalist optimism and post-functionalist pessimism: Integrating politicisation into integration theory. Working paper.
- Genschel, P. and Jachtenfuchs, M., 2018. From market integration to core state powers: the Eurozone crisis, the refugee crisis and integration theory. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56(1), pp.178-196.

Week 2: Institutional change and Institutionalism

Study Questions

1. While the neofunctionalist-intergovernmentalist debate enlightened our understanding of the integration process, new theories of EU politics have since emerged focusing on institutions. What are these theories and what types of questions do they attempt to address?
2. How has the focus of the theoretical debate changed in light of these new institutionalist theories?
3. What do the different ‘institutionalism’ have in common and how do they differ?

Required Reading

- Aspinwall, M.D. & Schneider, G. (2000). Same menu, separate tables: The institutional turn in political science and the study of European integration. *European Journal of Political Research*. 38(1): 1–36.
- Tsebelis, G. & Garrett, G. (2001) The Institutional Foundations of Intergovernmentalism and Supranationalism. *International Organization*. 55(2): 357-90.
- Pierson, P. (1996). The Path to European Integration: A Historical Institutional Analysis. *Comparative Political Studies*. 29(2): 123-163.
- Checkel, J.T. & Moravcsik, M. (2001). A Constructivist Research Programme in EU Studies? *European Union Politics*. 2(2): 219-49.

Further reading

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. 6th Edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapter 6.
- Moravcsik, A. & Nicolaidis, K. (1998). Explaining the Treaty of Amsterdam: Interests, Influence, Institutions. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 37: 59–85.
- Garrett, G. & Tsebelis, G. (1996). An Institutional Critique of Intergovernmentalism. *International Organization*. 50(02): 269–99.
- Hix, S. (1994). The Study of the European Community: The Challenge to Comparative Politics. *West European Politics*. 17: 1-30.
- Garrett, G. & Tsebelis, G. (1996). An Institutional Critique of Intergovernmentalism. *International Organization*. Vol. 50, No. 2, pp. 269-99.
- Christiansen, T., Jorgensen, K.E. & Wiener, A. (1999). The Social Construction of Europe. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 6: 528-44.
- Moravcsik, A. (1999). Is Something Rotten in the State of Denmark? Constructivism and European Integration. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 6(4).
- Checkel, J.T. & Moravcsik, A. (2001). A Constructivist Research Programme in EU Studies? *European Union Politics*. 2(2): 219-49.
- Jupille, J. & Caporaso, J.A. (1999). Institutionalism and the European Union: Beyond International Relations and Comparative Politics. *Annual Review of Political Science*. 2: 429–44.
- Aspinwall, M. & Schneider, G. eds. (2000). *The Rules of Integration: Institutional Approaches to the Study of Europe*. Manchester: Manchester University Press.

PART II: THE POLITICAL INSTITUTIONS OF THE EU AND ITS POLICY-MAKING PROCESS

Week 3: Negotiating the treaties

Study questions

- What are the sources of states' bargaining power during treaty negotiations? How do domestic constraints condition states' bargaining strength at IGCs?
- There is conflicting evidence regarding which players and what factors are most likely to affect the outcome of a treaty. What is the role of supranational actors in explaining IGC bargains?
- How has the Treaty of Lisbon shifted the EU's institutional balance of power between the major institutions of the EU?

Required Readings

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapter 3.
- Dörfler, T., Holzinger, K., & Biesenbender, J. (2017). Constitutional Dynamics in the European Union: Success, Failure, and Stability of Institutional Treaty Revisions. *International Journal of Public Administration*, 1-13.
- Slapin, J. B. (2008). Bargaining power at Europe's intergovernmental conferences: testing institutional and intergovernmental theories. *International Organization*. 62(01): 131-162.
- Finke, D. (2009). Challenges to intergovernmentalism: an empirical analysis of EU treaty negotiations since Maastricht. *West European Politics*. 32(3): 466-495.

Further reading

- Slapin, J. B. (2006). Who is powerful? Examining preferences and testing sources of bargaining strength at European intergovernmental conferences. *European Union Politics*. 7(1): 51-76.
- Schneider, C. J. (2013). Globalizing electoral politics: Political competence and distributional bargaining in the European Union. *World Politics*, 65(3), 452-490.
- Johansson, K. M. (2016). The role of Europarties in EU treaty reform: Theory and practice. *Acta Politica*, 1-20.
- Panke, D. (2017). Speech is silver, silence is golden? Examining state activity in international negotiations. *The Review of International Organizations*, 12(1), 121-146.
- Finke, D., König, T., Proksch, S.O., & Tsebelis, G. (2012). *Reforming the European Union: realizing the impossible*. New Jersey: Princeton University Press.

- Slapin, J. B. (2009). Exit, voice, and cooperation: Bargaining power in international organizations and federal systems. *Journal of Theoretical Politics*. 21(2): 187-211.
- Finke, D. (2010). *European integration and its limits: intergovernmental conflicts and their domestic origins*. ECPR Press.
- Franchino, F. (2013). Challenges to liberal intergovernmentalism. *European Union Politics*. 14(2): 324-337.
- Finke, D. (2009). Domestic Politics and European Treaty Reform Understanding the Dynamics of Governmental Position-Taking. *European Union Politics*. 10(4): 482-506.
- Reinhard, J., Biesenbender, J., & Holzinger, K. (2014). Do arguments matter? Argumentation and negotiation success at the 1997 Amsterdam Intergovernmental Conference. *European Political Science Review*. 6(02): 283-307.
- Finke, D. (2013). Reforming International Institutions: The Domestic Origins and Conditional Logic of Governmental Reform Preferences. *International Studies Quarterly*. 57(2): 288-302.
- Reinhard, J. (2012). Because we are all Europeans!'When do EU Member States use normative arguments?. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 19(9): 1336-1356.

Week 4: The EU as a Political System; the Commission and Executive Politics

Study Questions

1. Why do Member States choose to delegate policy-making powers to the supranational level? What types of problems does such delegation solve and what types of problems arise from the delegation decision?
2. Some recent studies find congruence between the Commission and member states' policy positions suggesting that the Commission might not be "completely independent in the performance of their duties" as specified in the treaty and not quite as supranational as it has been often portrayed. To what can we attribute this policy congruence? i.e., what are some of the key factors that constrain the Commission's independence and condition its policy positions, as identified in the readings?

Required Reading

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapter 10-11.
- Pollack, M.A., (1997). Delegation, agency, and agenda setting in the European Community. *International Organization*. 51(1): 99-134.
- Wonka, A. (2007). Technocratic and Independent? The Appointment of European Commissioners and its Policy Implications. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 14(2): 169-89.

- Klüver, H., Mahoney, C. and Oppen, M. (2015). Framing in context: how interest groups employ framing to lobby the European Commission. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(4), 481-498.

Further reading

- Egeberg, M. (2014). The European Commission: From agent to political institution. *Public Administration*, 92(1), 240-246.
- Ringe, N. (2005). Policy Preference Formation in Legislative Politics: Structures, Actors, and Focal Points. *American Journal of Political Science*. 49(4): 731-45.
- Thomson, R. (2008). National Actors in International Organizations: The Case of the European Commission. *Comparative Political Studies*. 41: 169-92.
- Hooghe, L. (2002). *The European Commission and the Integration of Europe*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Pollack, M.A. (2003). *The Engines of European Integration: Delegation, Agency and Agenda Setting in the European Union*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Egeberg, M. (2006). Executive Politics as Usual: Role Behaviour and Conflict Dimensions in the College of European Commissioners. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 13(1): 1-15.
- Franchino, F. (2009). Experience and the distribution of portfolio payoffs in the European Commission. *European Journal of Political Research*. 48(1): 1-30.
- Hooghe, L. (1999). Images of Europe: Orientations to European Integration Among Senior Officials of the Commission. *British Journal of Political Science*. 29: 345-367.
- Hooghe, L. (2002). *The European Commission and the Integration of Europe*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Hooghe, L. (2005). Several Roads Lead to International Norms, But Few via International Socialization: A Case Study of the European Commission. *International Organization*. 59: 861-898.
- Rasmussen, A. (2007). Challenging the Commission's Right of Initiative? Conditions for Institutional Change and Stability. *West European Politics*. 30(2): 244-64.
- Egeberg, M., Gornitzka, Å., & Trondal, J. (2014). A not so technocratic executive? Everyday interaction between the European Parliament and the Commission. *West European Politics*, 37(1), 1-18.
- Christensen, J. (2015). Recruitment and Expertise in the European Commission. *West European Politics*, 38(3), 649-678.
- Egeberg, M., Trondal, J., & Vestlund, N. M. (2015). The quest for order: unravelling the relationship between the European Commission and European Union agencies. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(5), 609-629.
- Wonka, A. (2008). 'Decision-Making Dynamics in the European Commission: Partisan, National or Sectoral?', *Journal of European Public Policy* 15(8), pp.1145-63.

- Hartlapp, M., Metz, J., & Rauh, C. (2014). *Which policy for Europe?: power and conflict inside the European Commission*. Oxford University Press.
- Egeberg, M., Trondal, J., & Vestlund, N. (2014). *Situating EU agencies in the political-administrative space*. ARENA Working Papers 6.
- Kassim, H. (2008). ‘“Mission Impossible”, but Mission Accomplished: the Kinnock Reforms and the European Commission’, *Journal of European Public Policy* 15(5), 648–68
- Smith, A., (2014). *How the European Commission’s Policies Are Made: Problematicization, Instrumentation and Legitimation*, *Journal of European Integration*, 36(1), 55-72.
- Schmidt, S.K. (2000). ‘Only an Agenda Setter? The European Commission’s Power Over the Council of Ministers’, *European Union Politics* 1(1), pp.37–61
- Peterson, J. (2012). “The College of Commissioners.” In: John Peterson & Michael Shackleton (eds.). *The Institutions of the European Union*. 3rd edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press: 96-123.
- Quittkat, C. (2011). *The European Commission’s Online Consultations: A Success Story?* *Journal of Common Market Studies* 49(3): 653-674.
- Eising, R., Rasch, D., & Rozbicka, P. (2015). *Institutions, policies, and arguments: context and strategy in EU policy framing*. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(4), 516-533.
- Vaznonytė, A., 2020. *The rotating Presidency of the Council of the EU–Still an agenda-setter?*. *European Union Politics*, 21(3) pp.497–518.
- Hobolt, S.B. and Wratil, C., 2020. *Contestation and responsiveness in EU Council deliberations*. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 27(3), pp.362-381.
- Rauh, C. 2019. *EU politicization and policy initiatives of the European Commission: the case of consumer policy*, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 26(3), pp.344-365
- Delreux, T. and Adriaensen, J. eds., 2017. *The Principal Agent Model and the European Union*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Delreux, T. and Adriaensen, J. 2017. *Twenty years of principal-agent research in EU politics: how to cope with complexity?*. *European Political Science*, pp.1-18.

Week 5: Legislative Politics & Policy making (The Council of Ministers and the European Parliament)

Study Questions

1. Is the European Parliament a “normal” Parliament? In what sense is it “normal” and in what sense (if any) does it remain unique or sui generis? How has this changed over time as the EU has been reformed?

2. What drives policy outcomes in the Council of Ministers?
3. How is the impact of the Council, Parliament and Commission mediated through the institutional structure and rules of the decision-making process? What factors impact upon a legislative actors ability to influence legislative outcomes?
4. How successful have the attempts to formally model the legislative process been at predicting legislative outcomes? Is this approach suitable for the task at hand? What aspects of the decision-making process might such models miss?
5. How might informal political arrangements reduce the difficulty associated with reaching agreements under more formal legislative procedures?

Required Reading

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- Kreppel, A. (2001). *The European Parliament and Supranational Party System: A Study in Institutional Development*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Cross, J.P. (2013). Everyone’s a winner (almost): Bargaining success in the Council of Ministers of the European Union. *European Union Politics*. 14(1): 70-94.
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Week 6: Judicial Politics

The ECJ, Judicial Politics and Compliance

Study Question

1. Describe the powers of the ECJ. Do these powers make the ECJ an independent court? What limits (both formal and informal) exist on the powers of the ECJ?
2. What do we mean by the term “judicial activism”? Does the ECJ engage in judicial activism often? How have member states reacted to examples of judicial activism by the ECJ?
3. Carruba et al. and Stone Sweet & Brunell disagree on the extent to which member states can act collectively to constrain the ECJ. Which account of ECJ power and influence is more convincing and why?
4. We observe significant variation in the levels of compliance with EU law both between Member States and over time. What can explain this variation?

Required Readings

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- Stone Sweet, A. (2010). The European Court of Justice and the Judicialization of EU Governance. *Living Reviews in European Governance*. 5(2).
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- Tallberg, J. (2004). European governance and supranational institutions: making states comply. Routledge.
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- Hartlapp, M. & Falkner, G. (2009). Problems of Operationalization and Data in EU Compliance Research. *European Union Politics*. 10(2): 281-304.
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- Toshkov, D. (2008). Embracing European law compliance with EU directives in Central and Eastern Europe. *European Union Politics*, 9(3), 379–402.
- Toshkov, D. (2010). Taking stock: a review of quantitative studies of transposition and implementation of EU law. Institute for European Integration Research.
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Week 7: Interest representation: Lobbying in Brussels

Study Question

- Describe the different access point through which lobbyists attempt to influence EU policy making. Do the institutional structures of the Commission, EP, and Council aid or hinder lobbyists in their lobbying attempts?
- What different types of factors have been identified as influencing lobbying success?
- What attempts have been made to regulate EU lobbying? Have these attempts been successful?

Key reading

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- European Commission for Democracy Through Law (Venice Commission). (2013). *Report on the Role of Extra-Institutional Actors in the Democratic System*. Available here: [http://www.venice.coe.int/webforms/documents/default.aspx?pdffile=CDL-AD\(2013\)011-e](http://www.venice.coe.int/webforms/documents/default.aspx?pdffile=CDL-AD(2013)011-e)
- Flöthe, L. and Rasmussen, A., 2018. Public voices in the heavenly chorus? Group type bias and opinion representation. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-19.
- Bouwen, P. (2004): Exchanging access goods for access: A comparative study of business lobbying in the European Union Institutions. *European Journal of Political Research*. 43: 337-369.
- Dür, A., Bernhagen, P., and Marshall, D. (2015). Interest Group Success in the European Union When (and Why) Does Business Lose?. *Comparative Political Studies*, 48(8), pp.951-983.

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- Flöthe, L. and Rasmussen, A., 2018. Public voices in the heavenly chorus? Group type bias and opinion representation. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-19.
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- Wonka, A., De Bruycker, I., De Bièvre, D., Braun, C., and Beyers, J. 2018. Patterns of Conflict and Mobilization: Mapping Interest Group Activity in EU Legislative Policymaking. *Politics and Governance*, 6(3), 136-146.
- Hollman, M. and Murdoch, Z. 2018. Lobbying cycles in Brussels: Evidence from the rotating presidency of the Council of the European Union. *European Union Politics*, 19(4), pp.597-616.
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- van der Graaf, A., Otjes, S. and Rasmussen, A. 2016. Weapon of the weak? The social media landscape of interest groups. *European Journal of Communication*, 31(2), pp.120-135.
- De Bruycker, I. 2016. Pressure and Expertise: Explaining the Information Supply of Interest Groups in EU Legislative Lobbying. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 54(3), pp.599-616.
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- Marshall, D. (2010) Who to Lobby and When: Institutional Determinants of Interest Group Strategies in European Parliament Committees. *European Union Politics*. 11(4): 553-575.
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- Coen, D & Richardson, J (eds.) (2009). *Lobbying the European Union*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Dür, A. (2008). Interest groups in the European Union: How Powerful are They? *West European Politics*. 31(6): 1212-1230.
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- Eising, R. (2008). Interest Group in EU policymaking. *Living Reviews in European Governance*. Vol. 3 (<http://europeangovernance.livingreviews.org/Articles/lreg-2008-4/>).
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- Greenwood, J. (2007b). Review Article: Organized Civil Society and Democratic Legitimacy in the EU. *British Journal of Political Science*. 37: 333-35.
- Klüver, H. (2010). Measuring Interest Group Influence using Quantitative Text Analysis. *European Union Politics*. 10(4): 535- 549.
- Mahoney, C. (2008). *Brussels versus the Beltway. Advocacy in the United States and the European Union*. Washington DC: Georgetown University Press.
- Quittkat, C. (2011). The European Commission's Online Consultations: a Success Story? *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 49(3): 653-674.
- Skodvin, T., Gullberg, A.T., & Aakre, S. (2010). Target-group influence and political feasibility: the case of climate policy design in Europe. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 17(6): 854-873.

Week 8: Reading week - no class

Week 9: Peer review workshop

Exercise

1. Write a 2-page review of the draft paper distributed by the lecturer. Utilise the guidelines provided to do so. These reviews will be considered in class and used as the basis for the seminar.

Required Readings

- Distributed draft paper
- Guidelines for workshop

Week 10: The EU budget

Study questions

- What actors and institutions are involved in negotiating the EU budget?
- How are the powers of these actors to shape the EU budget influenced by the institutional rules structuring the budget-making process?
- How has the budget-making process in the EU evolved over time?

Required Readings

- Citi, M. (2015). European Union budget politics: Explaining stability and change in spending allocations. *European Union Politics*. 16(2). 260-280.
- Crombez, C. & Høyland, B. (2015). The budgetary procedure in the European Union and the implications of the Treaty of Lisbon. *European Union Politics*. 16(1): 67–89.
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Further reading

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- Citi, M. (2014). Reforming the EU budget: A Time Series Analysis of Institutional and Partisan Effects. Available here: http://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=2432087.
- Alt, J. E. & Lassen, D. D. (2006). Transparency, political polarization, and political budget cycles in OECD countries. *American Journal of Political Science*. 50(3): 530–550.
- Bailer, S., Mattila, M., & Schneider, G. (2015). Money makes the EU go round: The objective foundations of conflict in the council of ministers. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 53(3): 437-456.
- Blavoukos, S. & Pagoulatos, G. (2011). Accounting for coalition-building in the European Union: Budget negotiations and the south. *European Journal of Political Research*. 50(4): 559–581.
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- Jones, B. D., Baumgartner, F. R., Breunig, C., et al. (2009). A general empirical law of public budgets: A comparative analysis. *American Journal of Political Science*. 53(4): 855–873.
- König, T. & Troeger, V. E. (2005). Budgetary politics and veto players. *Swiss Political Science Review*. 11(4): 47–75.
- Laffan, B. (2000). The big budgetary bargains: From negotiation to authority. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 7(5): 725–743.
- Mink, M. & de Haan, J. (2006). Are there political budget cycles in the euro area? *European Union Politics*. 7(2): 191–211.

Week 11: The Democratic Deficit, Democratic Legitimacy and Legislative Transparency

Study Questions

1. What is the EU's "democratic deficit"? What are the fundamental causes of this deficit, and why is it unlikely to be fixed in the near future? Why does Moravcsik argue that the EU is not particularly "broken" and so should not be "fixed"? Why, finally, do Follesdal & Hix believe that the democratic deficit is more serious than Moravcsik (and another analyst, Giandomenico Majone) thinks, and what do they recommend as to fix the problem? Which view do you find most convincing, and why?
2. The Laeken declaration (2001) states that: "the European project [...] derives its legitimacy from democratic, transparent and efficient institutions". At the same time, transparency is seen by Naurin as a necessary but not sufficient condition for democratic accountability in the European Union. How transparent is the EU in general and the legislative process in particular. Has this changed over time? What are the implications of the current levels of transparency in EU politics for the aforementioned democratic deficit? Finally, can the EU be simultaneously democratic transparent and efficient?

Required Readings

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- The European Council. (2001). *The Laeken declaration*. Available here: <http://european-convention.eu.int/pdf/1knen.pdf>
- Moravcsik, A. (2002). In Defense of the Democratic Deficit: Reassessing Legitimacy in the European Union. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 40(4): 603-624.
- Follesdal, A. & Hix, S. (2006). Why there is a democratic deficit in the EU: A response to Majone and Moravcsik. *Journal of common market studies*. 44(3): 533-562.
- Cross, J.P. (2013a). Striking a pose: transparency and position taking in the Council of the European Union. *European Journal of Political Research*. 52(3): 291-315.
- Cross, J.P. (2014). The seen and the unseen in legislative politics: explaining censorship in the Council of Ministers of the European Union. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 21(2): 268-285.

Further reading

The Democratic Deficit and Legislative Transparency

- Brandsma, G.J. 2018. Transparency of EU informal trilogues through public feedback in the European Parliament: promise unfulfilled. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-20.
- Kreuder-Sonnen, C. 2018. Political secrecy in Europe: crisis management and crisis exploitation. *West European Politics*, 41(4), pp.958-980.
- Blatter, J., Schmid, S. D., and Blättler, A. C. (2017) Democratic Deficits in Europe: The Overlooked Exclusiveness of Nation-States and the Positive Role of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 55: 449-467.

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- Hobolt, S.B. (2012). Citizen Satisfaction with Democracy in the European Union*. *Journal of Common Market Studies*. 50(s1): 88–105.
- Majone, G. (1998). Europe’s “democratic deficit”: The question of standards. *European Law Journal*. 4(1): 5–28.
- Stasavage, D. (2004). Open-door or closed-door? Transparency in domestic and international bargaining. *International Organization*. 58(04): 667–703.
- Stasavage, D. (2007). Polarization and publicity: rethinking the benefits of deliberative democracy. *Journal of Politics*. 69(1): 59–72.
- Zweifel, T.D. (2002). ... Who is without sin cast the first stone: the EU’s democratic deficit in comparison. *Journal of European Public Policy*. 9(5): 812–840.

Week 12: Brexit, public opinion, and the future of the EU

Study Questions

1. What drives public opinion about the EU? Can traditional explanations of public opinion help us understand the Brexit vote?
2. The balance of power in the Brexit negotiations is heavily in favour of the EU, why is this? What (if anything) might the UK be able to do to mitigate its disadvantaged bargaining position?
3. What are the implications of Brexit for the future of the EU?

Required Readings

- Cini, M. & Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (2019). *European Union Politics*. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapter 27 & 28.
- Hobolt, S. B. 2016. The Brexit vote: a divided nation, a divided continent. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 23(9), pp.1259-1277.

- Springford, J. 2018. Theresa May's Irish trilemma. <https://www.cer.eu/insights/theresa-mays-irish-trilemma>.
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- Laffan, B. 2018. Brexit: Re-opening Ireland's English Question. *The Political Quarterly*, 89, pp.568-575.
- Huhe, N., Naurin, D. and Thomson, R., 2020. Don't cry for me Britannia: The resilience of the European Union to Brexit. *European Union Politics*, 21(1), pp.152-172.

Further reading

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- Yordanova, N., Angelova, M., Lehrer, R., Osnabrügge, M. and Renes, S., 2020. Swaying citizen support for EU membership: Evidence from a survey experiment of German voters. *European Union Politics*, 21(3), pp.429–450.
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- Richardson, J. 2018. Brexit: The EU Policy-Making State Hits the Populist Buffers. *The Political Quarterly*, 89, pp.118-126.
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